

Oracle Forms Interview Questions & Answers

1. What is Oracle Forms?

Oracle Forms is a tool from Oracle used to build data entry applications that interact with Oracle Databases. It provides a GUI for end-users and uses PL/SQL for business logic.

2. What are Triggers in Oracle Forms?

Triggers are PL/SQL blocks that execute in response to events. Examples include form-level (WHEN-NEW-FORM-INSTANCE), block-level (WHEN-NEW-BLOCK-INSTANCE), and item-level (WHEN-VALIDATE-ITEM).

3. What is a Canvas in Oracle Forms?

A canvas is the visual layout surface on which items (text boxes, buttons) are placed. Types include Content Canvas, Stacked Canvas, Tab Canvas, Toolbar Canvas.

4. What is the difference between Data Block and Control Block?

Data Block is linked to a database table or view. Control Block is not linked to any table and is used for user input or controls.

5. What is LOV (List of Values)?

An LOV is a pop-up window that shows a list of values (fetched via SQL query) for the user to select from.

6. What is a Record Group?

A Record Group is an in-memory data structure that stores query results. It's used with LOVs or for dynamic data handling.

7. What is the difference between Pre-Query and Post-Query?

Pre-Query executes before running a query; used to set query conditions. Post-Query fires after a query and runs per record.

8. What is WHEN-VALIDATE-ITEM Trigger?

This trigger is used to validate data after the user exits an item (field).

9. How do you call a report from Oracle Forms?

Use `RUN_REPORT_OBJECT(report_id, parameters)`; or use `HOST` command for external reports.

10. Common Built-in Functions in Oracle Forms

`:SYSTEM.CURSOR_BLOCK`, `:SYSTEM.MESSAGE_LEVEL`, `GET_BLOCK_PROPERTY()`,
`SHOW_ALERT()`, `DO_KEY('EXECUTE_QUERY')`

11. How do you handle error messages in Oracle Forms?

Use `ON-ERROR` or `ON-MESSAGE` triggers to show custom messages instead of system defaults.

12. Can you create a login screen in Oracle Forms?

Yes. Use a control block to take input, validate with SQL, and navigate to the main form.

13. Difference between POST and COMMIT?

`POST` writes to the session memory; `COMMIT` saves changes permanently to the database.

14. How do you debug Oracle Forms?

Use `MESSAGE()`, `SYNCHRONIZE`, or the built-in Forms Builder debugger.

15. How do you open another form from the current form?

Use `CALL_FORM('form_name')`; to pause current form and open another.

Advanced Tips

Know triggers like `PRE-INSERT`, `WHEN-NEW-FORM-INSTANCE`, etc. Be able to explain PL/SQL blocks and integrate Oracle Reports/WebLogic.